USER MANUAL

TB EQ

Version: 2.0.0 | Documentation date: 2026-08-04

Overview

Shapes tone and controls harsh, boomy, or distracting frequencies with up to 24 precise bands.

What this plug-in solves

Static EQ solves stable tonal problems but cannot follow level-dependent harshness. Broadband compression reacts to level but often affects more spectrum than necessary. TB EQ places static shape, dynamic movement, and spectral resonance control inside the same per-band workflow so tonal balance and problem control remain localized.

What you can expect

- Precise static shaping across as many as 24 bands
- Level-dependent cuts or boosts
- Narrow spectral resonance reduction
- Channel-selective and delta monitoring workflows

How it works

TB EQ divides tone shaping into independent bands. A static band makes a consistent change, a dynamic band moves only when that frequency area becomes too strong or too weak, and spectral control follows narrow resonances inside the selected area instead of moving the whole band equally.

Each of the twenty-four bands uses the same control set, so the manual explains that shared set once rather than repeating identical instructions. Frequency locates the sound, Gain sets the direction, Q defines the focus, and the optional dynamic or spectral section decides when the change should move. Delta listening helps confirm that the intended sound, rather than useful nearby tone, is being affected.

Quick start

1. Start at 0 dB Input and Output Gain.
2. Create or select a band and choose the static filter type.

3. Set Frequency, Gain, and Q while listening in context.
4. Enable Dynamic for level-dependent movement or Spectral for narrow resonance control.
5. Use delta/audition to verify the target.
6. Repeat only as needed and level-match the output.

Interface and key sections

This is a direct capture of the current plug-in interface. Use the visible labels to locate the areas and controls explained below.

Band creation and selection

Create, select, enable, or delete bands from the analyzer and band selector. Dragging a node changes frequency and gain, while the mouse wheel changes Q. The shared band controls are explained once below because every band works the same way.

Static filter types

Each band provides the available Bell, shelf, cut, notch, pass, and all-pass shapes. Frequency, Gain, Q, and Channel Mode define the basic response.

Dynamic EQ

Dynamic mode adds Threshold, Range, Ratio, Attack, and Release behavior to the static band. Range determines the maximum direction and amount of movement.

Spectral processing

Spectral mode uses short-time spectral analysis to detect narrow components around the selected band. Sensitivity, depth/range, attenuation, and related controls determine what is reduced and by how much.

Mutual processing modes

Dynamic and Spectral layers are intended as distinct per-band processes. Use the mode that matches the problem instead of stacking two detectors on one band.

Channel and delta tools

Channel Mode targets the relevant stereo component. Delta Band, Delta Mode, and monitor/audition behavior isolate what a band or processing layer is changing.

Analyzer

The display combines the live spectrum, static curve, expected dynamic/spectral range, and real-time movement. Visuals confirm behavior but do not replace listening.

Controllable properties

The guide uses the names shown on the plug-in panel. Each explanation describes the audible result, a useful way to approach the control, and an important interaction to listen for.

Control	What it does and when to use it
Band 1-24: Attenuation	Sets how much of the selected resonance is removed or heard in the isolated listening mode. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Band 1-24: Channel Mode	Chooses which stereo channel or center/side area this band changes. Compare the available characters on the same short passage. Choose by the musical result rather than by the name of the mode.
Band 1-24: Dynamic	Lets this band move only when the selected frequency becomes louder or quieter. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Band 1-24: Dynamic Attack	Sets how quickly the band reacts to a new peak in the selected frequency. Judge this control while the source repeats in the full arrangement. The right timing should support the groove without making the sound feel detached.
Band 1-24: Dynamic Range	Limits how far the band can move when dynamic control is active. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Band 1-24: Dynamic Ratio	Sets how strongly the band reacts after it crosses the threshold. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Band 1-24: Dynamic Release	Sets how quickly the band returns after the selected frequency settles. Set it in relation to the rhythm and the space between events. Listen for pumping, gaps, or a tail that covers the next sound.
Band 1-24: Dynamic Threshold	Sets how loud the selected frequency must be before dynamic movement begins. Move it until the section reacts too often, then back away until it follows only the events you actually want to control.
Band 1-24: Enabled	Turns this EQ band on or off. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.

Control	What it does and when to use it
Band 1-24: Frequency	Chooses the tonal area this band changes. Sweep broadly to find the useful tonal area, then make the focus narrower and the change smaller while listening in the full mix.
Band 1-24: Gain	Raises or lowers the selected tonal area. Raise it until the contribution is obvious, then reduce it slightly and recheck the sound in the complete mix.
Band 1-24: Q	Sets how wide or narrow the tonal change is. Sweep broadly to find the useful tonal area, then make the focus narrower and the change smaller while listening in the full mix.
Band 1-24: Spectral	Turns on focused control of narrow resonances around this band. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Band 1-24: Spectral Depth	Sets how strongly detected resonances are reduced. Set the speed first and then add only enough movement to hear the pattern without pulling attention away from the performance.
Band 1-24: Spectral Niddle	Focuses the control on narrower, more noticeable resonances. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Band 1-24: Spectral Range	Limits the maximum resonance reduction around this band. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.
Band 1-24: Spectral Sensitivity	Sets how easily narrow resonances are selected for control. Move it until the section reacts too often, then back away until it follows only the events you actually want to control.
Band 1-24: Type	Chooses the filter shape for this band. Compare the available characters on the same short passage. Choose by the musical result rather than by the name of the mode.
Bypass	Turns the complete effect off or on for a direct before-and-after comparison. Compare with bypass at a similar loudness. If the effect creates a tail, let that tail settle before judging the difference.
Delta Band	Chooses which band you hear when isolating only the sound changed by that band. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.

Control	What it does and when to use it
Delta Mode	Chooses whether isolated listening follows one band or the current EQ processing mode. Compare the available characters on the same short passage. Choose by the musical result rather than by the name of the mode.
Input Gain	Sets how loud the sound enters the plug-in. Raise it for a stronger response or lower it for more headroom. Match the final loudness before deciding whether the processing sounds better. Extra level can make almost any setting seem more impressive.
Output Gain	Sets the final listening level after processing. Match the final loudness before deciding whether the processing sounds better. Extra level can make almost any setting seem more impressive.
Program	Loads a factory starting point. Adjust the controls afterward to fit the current sound. Use a preset as a direction, not a finished answer. Change one section at a time so it is clear which adjustment improves the source.

Practical uses

Harsh vocal resonance

- Create a narrow Bell at the harsh frequency.
- Keep static Gain near neutral if the harshness is intermittent.
- Enable Spectral mode and lower Sensitivity until only the resonance reacts.
- Set a conservative reduction range and audition the removed component.

Expected result: Harsh peaks are controlled while surrounding vocal tone remains open.

Dynamic low-mid cleanup

- Create a broad Bell in the buildup region.
- Enable Dynamic mode with a negative Range.
- Set Threshold for loud phrases and tune Attack/Release to follow the phrase envelope.

Expected result: Low-mid density is reduced only when it becomes excessive.

Mastering tone

- Use very broad Q values and small gains.
- Work in channel modes only when the imbalance is clearly localized.
- Use Output Gain for matched comparison.

Expected result: The balance changes subtly without unnecessary phase or dynamics movement.

Common pitfalls

Twenty-four active dynamic or spectral bands can be CPU intensive. Use the lighter quality setting while recording and reserve the heavier option for playback or export. Change latency-related modes while playback is stopped.

Narrow boosts can create large peaks. Reduce the main amount, feedback, drive, or input first, then rebuild the sound while watching the output meter and listening after the source stops.

Delta monitoring is diagnostic and should be returned to normal before export. Return the strongest control toward neutral, compare with bypass at a similar loudness, and add the processing back one section at a time.